

Fundraising Guide





Why Raise Money? Money is a tool God uses to help us live and love like Jesus. Regardless of how much – or how little – money we have, God is at work in our lives through our circumstances, and He is leading us to a deeper trust in him. (Reference: Jesse Wisnewski – Tithe.ly)

Fundraising Is Ministry!

Fundraising is ministry when we present to the world a Kingdom vision and invite others to join in a specific mission. It doesn't matter if we are the ones asking or giving, God is bringing His people together in collaboration to accomplish His work. When those with money and those who need money share a common mission, then we see a central sign of new life in the Spirit of Jesus Christ. The giver and the receiver both meet on the common ground of God's love. When this happens we can truly say, "There is a new creation!" (2 Cor. 5:17) (reference: Loretto Foundation)

First Things First

- You are raising funds for LST, not just for your particular LST project. Click <https://lst.org/projects/general-financial-information/> to see LST Financial Policy.
- You are inviting – not begging. Giving in support of ministry brings people great joy! This is an opportunity for donors to participate in life-changing ministry.
- You should raise funds even if you don't think you need to. God brings people together in collaboration to accomplish His work!
- God will provide what you need! (2 Cor. 9:8)

Amount Due	Due Date
\$2,000	90 days prior to departure
100%	30 days prior to departure

Use the space below to write how much you need to raise and what your actual fundraising deadlines are:

My fundraising goal _____

First fundraising deadline _____

Last fundraising deadline _____

How should I think about fundraising?

Before you actually begin fundraising, it's critical to examine the way we think about fundraising.

Successful fundraisers don't just DO the right kinds of things; they THINK the right kinds of thoughts.

First, pray. We don't make people give. We just ask. God opens hearts in response to our asking.

Our primary job in fundraising is simply to ask. So, pray now. Pray tomorrow. Pray every day of this fundraising journey.'

Second, develop a healthy framework for fundraising. Fundraising is not something we do in order to get to the real ministry; it is part of our ministry. There is an emotional and psychological aspect to raising support. We may hinder our own efforts at fundraising if we're carrying negative emotions, thoughts, or even the memories of negative experiences with us as we move forward.

As you contemplate specific action steps to take, meditate on the following principles from Scripture:

God is creator, owner, and provider.

And God will generously provide all you need.

Then you will always have everything you need and plenty left over to share with others.

– 2 Cor. 9:8

We are all stewards.

God has given each of you a gift from his great variety of spiritual gifts. Use them well to serve one another. – 1 Peter 4:10

There is a special blessing for those who give.

You should remember the words of the Lord Jesus: "It is more blessed to give than to receive." – Acts 20:35

God uses people to financially support His work.

Soon afterward Jesus began a tour of the nearby towns and villages, preaching and announcing the Good News about the Kingdom of God. He took his twelve disciples with him, along with some women who had been cured of evil spirits and diseases. Among them were Mary Magdalene, from whom he had cast out seven demons; Joanna, the wife of Chuza, Herod's business manager; Susanna; and many others who were contributing from their own resources to support Jesus and his disciples. – Luke 8:1-3

Always be thankful.

Be thankful in all circumstances, for this is God's will for you who belong to Christ Jesus. – 1 Thess. 5:18

What is my Fundraising Strategy?

While there are a number of factors that might impact your fundraising, some strategies seem to yield greater results. Consider the following response rates when mapping out your strategy:

Face-to-face – Expect a 75%-80% response rate.

Phone – Expect a 50%-60% response rate.

Written or Electronic Requests (such as letter writing) – Expect a 15%-20% response rate.



Person-to-Person Fundraising

- Asking your friends and family face-to-face (or phone-to-phone)
- You will raise more funds more quickly using this strategy.
- Relationally this is a powerful means of building a fundraising team.
- Because the response rate is higher you may actually raise all your funds from a smaller group of donors.

Tips for Person-to-Person Fundraising

- Make a list of the people you want to talk to.
- Create a small script for your interaction and practice it.
- Where you're going and who you're going with
 - The need LST is addressing:
 - LST provides a meaningful way for Christians to serve others.
 - LST provides a vehicle for sharing faith non-confrontationally.
 - LST provides a bridge for mission churches to reach into their neighborhoods.
 - LST meets these needs by offering one-to-one English conversation practice; free of charge; Scripture-based conversations; non-confrontational; etc.
 - Your financial need
 - The "ask" – "Can you be part of my support team?"
- Show them you have a plan: For example: "I'm asking 39 people to each give \$100 to meet my goal. Would you be willing to help?"
- If calling:
 - It's ok to leave a message, but call again later.
 - Call during convenient times: 4 p.m.-8 p.m.
 - Be confident and specific with your conversation. It helps to write out what you want to say.
- Provide a way for them to respond immediately (link to online donation page)



E-Strategies (Social media and email)

- Short, concise, fundraising requests to a larger network of potential donors
- Easier to include photos and/or video
- Doesn't cost anything
- Can be forwarded/shared by others
- Less likely to be read or noticed
- Very short "shelf life"
- Can send requests more often - which counters some of the negatives mentioned above

Example Two-Week Social Media Blitz:

Schedule messages about your trip and your fundraising request to go out once a day, Monday-Friday, for two weeks. Use a message on Saturday and Sunday to highlight

something you're looking forward to about your project. Don't ask in those messages. Grab attention by emphasizing this is a two-week blitz. Consider having a goal for your blitz "I need to raise \$2,000 during this two week blitz..."

Tips for E-Strategies

- Create several short descriptions of your project and your fundraising needs. Be concise!
 - Include photos – your team, your training, your site, etc.
 - Ask others to share your requests to their networks.
 - Always include a link to your online donation page..)
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Letter Writing

- Can be a good supplement to other fundraising methods.
- Can set the stage for person-to-person fundraising. "I'll be calling you in the next few days to let you know more about how to join me..."
- Longer "shelf life"
- Will generally have a low response rate
- Can be labor intensive (printing letters, printing envelopes, stuffing, etc.)

Tips for Letter Writing

- Be concise. Not more than one page.
 - Personalize each letter.
 - Sign each letter.
 - Include a link to your fundraising page. Encourage online giving but provide a response envelope in case they need to send a check.
 - Include your fundraising deadlines.
 - If relying on this for your primary means of fundraising, you will probably have to send 2-3 rounds of letters. Use a previous list as your starting point, such as Christmas cards, graduation announcements, or other similar events.
 - Plan to send out at least 100-200 letters.
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General Fundraising Tips

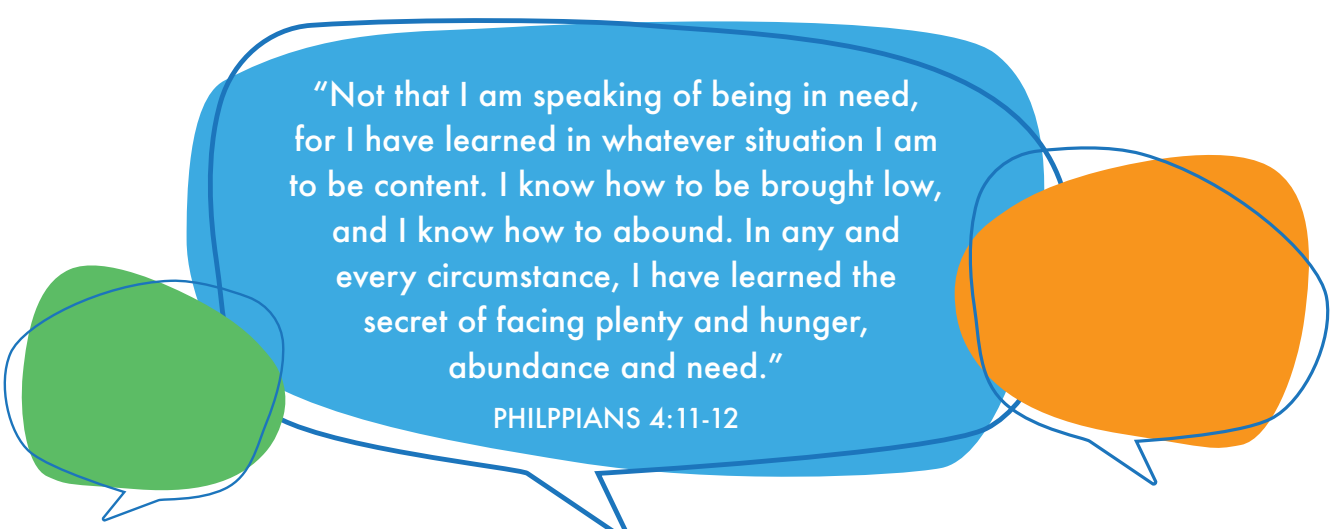
- Make your "ask" about the donor not about you. Help them see what will happen when they give – a Reader will have the opportunity to improve their English, a church will gain access to new relationships in their community, etc.
- Tell stories such as how you decided to go, what training is like, stories from the LST about Readers and Workers, etc.
- Always ask for a specific amount and give a specific deadline for giving.
- Urgency motivates people to give, so continue asking right up to the last minute.
- Ask people who have supported you before.
- The easiest way for people to give is online. Encourage donors to give through your LST web page.

40 Years of LST Fundraising Experience

- Most contributions come from individuals you know well, not from church budgets.
- Don't pre-judge who will give or how much they will give. You may be surprised at who gives and who doesn't.
- Fundraising is rewarding and faith-building, but it takes work.
- For some people the donations come quickly, and for others they come very slowly.
- People are more likely to give if they know you are fully committed. Never say, "If I raise my funds then I'm going..."
- Some donors may wait to give until they know their donation is really needed, so make your request with urgency.
- God will bless your efforts, if you will show Him your diligence.

Sample Phrases to use in your communication:

- "I will be sharing the story of Jesus with people every day, while we help them practice their conversational English."
- "We are serving people by helping them improve their conversation English using God's word."
- "I'd love to call/meet and tell you about this opportunity. Would X day/time work?"
- "I've committed to raise (amount) for LST."
- "My fundraising goal is (amount), and my first deadline is (date)."
- "I'm asking (#) people to give \$100 each to help me meet my goal."
- "The easiest way to give is online. Here's the link to my LST fundraising page..."
- "Could you be part of my support team?"
- When someone says "No":
 - "I understand that this may not be a good time. If you don't mind, could I check back with you next month to see if that's a better time?"
 - "I understand. Could I add you to my report list so that I can keep you updated on my project?"
- When someone says, "Let me get back to you about your request:"
 - "Sure! Could I contact you next Friday and see if you've had time to consider my request?"
- "Do you know anyone else who might be interested in supporting me in this LST project?"
- "Thank you!"



"Not that I am speaking of being in need,
for I have learned in whatever situation I am
to be content. I know how to be brought low,
and I know how to abound. In any and
every circumstance, I have learned the
secret of facing plenty and hunger,
abundance and need."

PHILPPIANS 4:11-12

Sample Letter:

Dear Sandra,

I'm going on Let's Start Talking mission project this spring! This March 16-30 I will be traveling to Lecce, Italy with two other teammates, and I'd love to have you become part of my support team.

Since 1981 LST has been sending students and adults from across North America to serve at mission sites around the world. LST provides all my training, logistical support, site support, and stays connected with me and my team from start to finish.

LST Workers help create life-changing conversations! We'll help people in the community practice English conversation in a one-to-one environment, using Scripture as the basis of our non-confrontational conversations.

Many of the people LST serves have little to no experience reading the Bible, and often they are unfamiliar with the story of Jesus. So, these conversations sessions lead to amazing discussions about life, relationships, and Jesus! Through LST God is:

- Changing individual Christians as they serve others and share their faith
- Shaping churches and universities as people experience His work around the world
- Transforming lives as new people experience His powerful Word
- Connecting mission churches with new relationships in their communities

I can't wait to serve in Italy by helping people practice their English, building meaningful friendships, and having authentic conversations about faith and life.

My fundraising goal for this project is [\$X], which is due by [date]. Will you be my partner by contributing \$100, \$200, or perhaps even more before my fundraising deadline?

Thank you for considering this opportunity. Please pray for the LST ministry and my mission project, and thank you for all your support and encouragement.

My best,

[Your hand-written signature]

P.S. The quickest and easiest way to give toward my project is to give online at [personalized fundraising link].

Action Plan

Fill out the chart below by indicating an action you will take, the date by which you'll take that action, and the amount of support you anticipate the action will bring. Keep in mind the different response rates mentioned above.

Action Summary	By Date	Amount Anticipated
For example: Call 10 potential donors to set up ask-appointments	February 1	NA
For example: Meet with 5 donors to ask face-to-face or online	February 15	\$1,000

Helpful Info About LST

Let's Start Talking has been powerfully connecting people around the world through one-on-one English conversation practice since 1980. LST's unique approach is an organic way to offer people something they genuinely want – a friend who will help them practice their conversational English – as well as something they need – God's word. LST equips volunteers and churches with the training and materials to connect with their international neighbors through English, friendship, and the Word of God.

LST's unique approach utilizes a one-to-one structure that allows the "Reader" to build on the English skills they already have. The LST workbooks bring Biblical stories to life and foster conversations about different perspectives, everyday life topics, and faith experiences. We believe that a friendly relationship and the exchange of personal insights is key to developing stronger language skills. LST is recognized world-wide as innovators of a unique approach to language learning, the results of which are heart-felt conversations about faith, love, and the source of abundant life.

